Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with flow desinger

Project Documentation Phase

Introduction

Project Documentation is an important phase in the development of the “Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer” project. Documentation provides a complete record of how the solution is planned, designed, configured, tested, and implemented in ServiceNow.

In this project, the documentation explains the complete laptop procurement process, starting from the employee submitting a standard laptop request through the Service Catalog and continuing through approval, fulfillment, notification, and completion. It also records the Flow Designer configuration, business requirements, testing results, user instructions, and maintenance information.

Proper documentation ensures that the project can be easily understood by developers, administrators, IT teams, and future users. It also helps in troubleshooting problems and making future changes to the automation.

1. **Project Overview**

The main objective of this project is to automate the standard laptop procurement process using ServiceNow Flow Designer.

In a traditional manual process, an employee may submit a laptop request and the IT team may need to manually review the request, obtain approval, create fulfillment tasks, update the request status, and communicate with the employee.

The automated solution simplifies this process by connecting the Service Catalog with Flow Designer.

The overall process can be represented as:

Employee → Service Catalog → Laptop Request → Approval → Flow Designer →Fulfilments Task → Notification → Completion

This automated process provides a structured method for handling standard laptop requests.

2. Business Requirement Documentation

The business requirement explains why the organization needs an automated laptop procurement process.

Main Requirements

Employees should be able to request a standard laptop.

The request should capture all required information.

The request should follow the required approval process.

Appropriate fulfillment tasks should be created automatically.

The responsible IT or procurement team should receive the task.

Employees should receive relevant notifications.

Request status should be updated throughout the process.

The entire process should be traceable.

Documentation of these requirements helps ensure that the developed solution matches the intended business process.

3. Service Catalog Documentation

The Service Catalog acts as the starting point for the laptop procurement process.

A catalog item named Standard Laptop Request can be created for employees.

Important Catalog Fields

Requested For

Laptop Model

Business Justification

Required Date

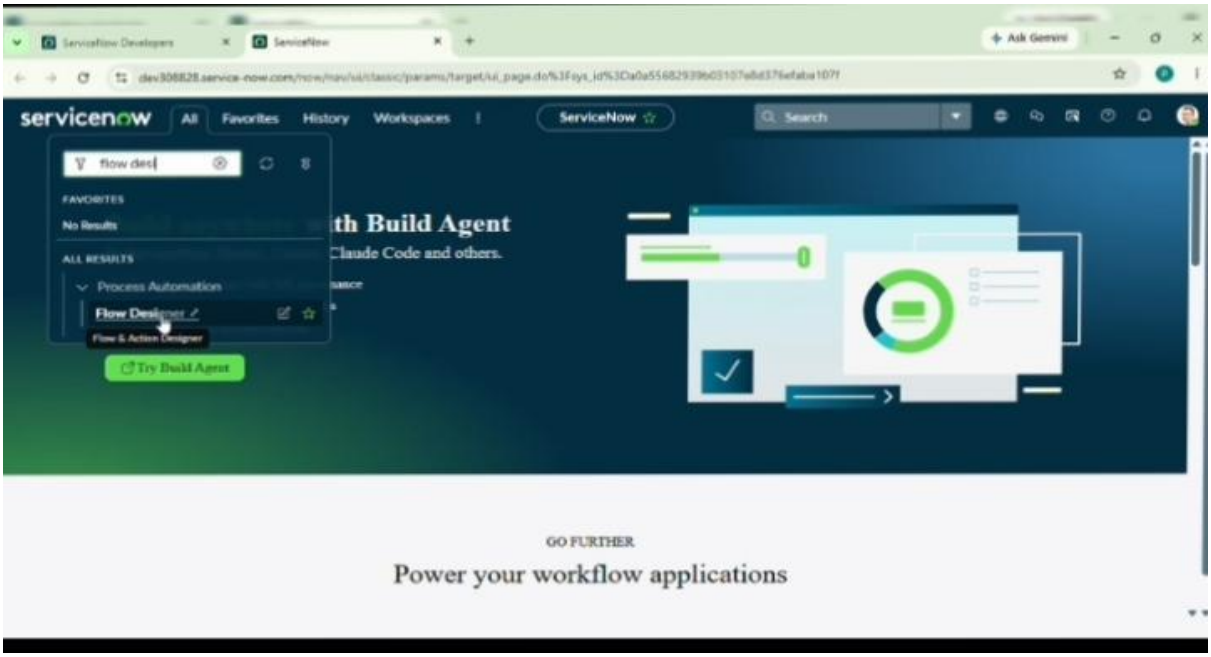
Additional Requirements

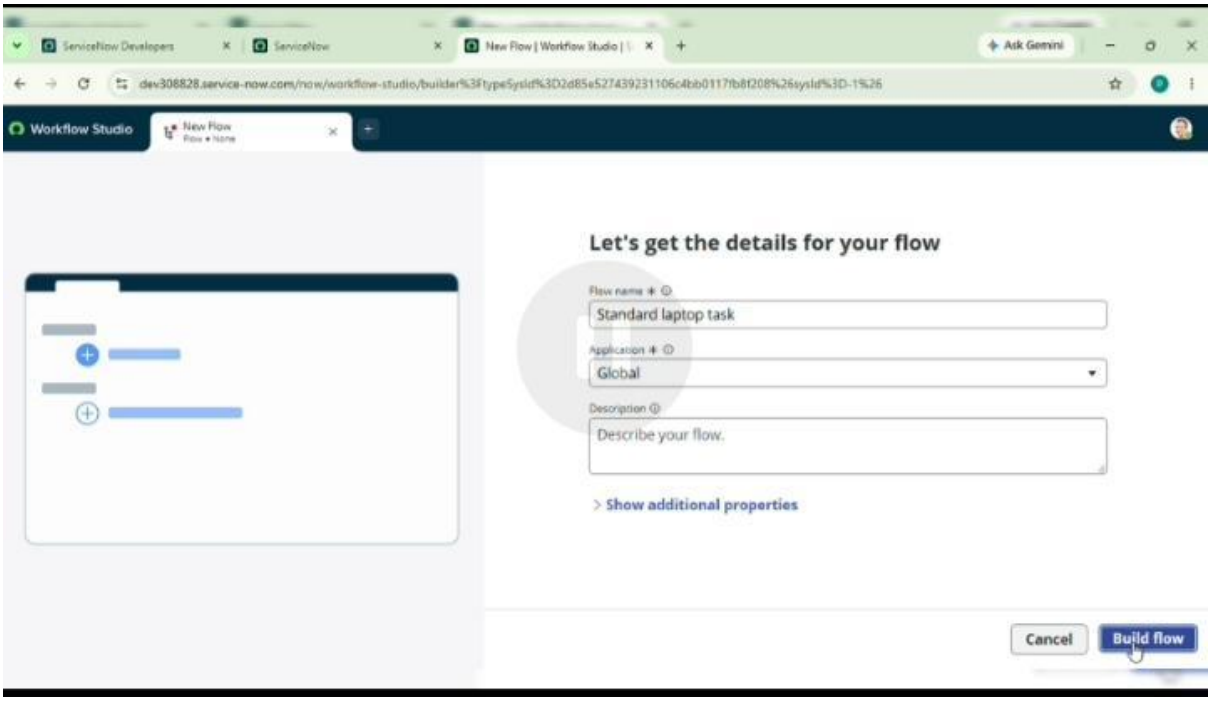
Employee Information

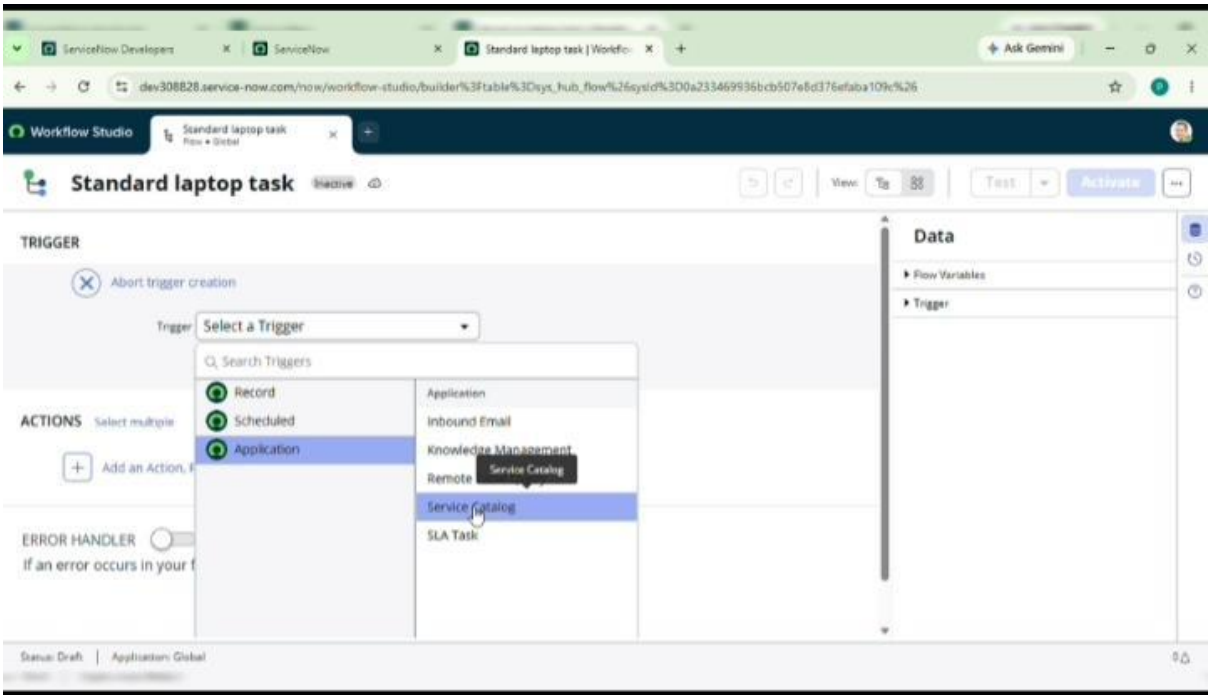
Each field should be documented with its purpose and whether it is mandatory or optional.

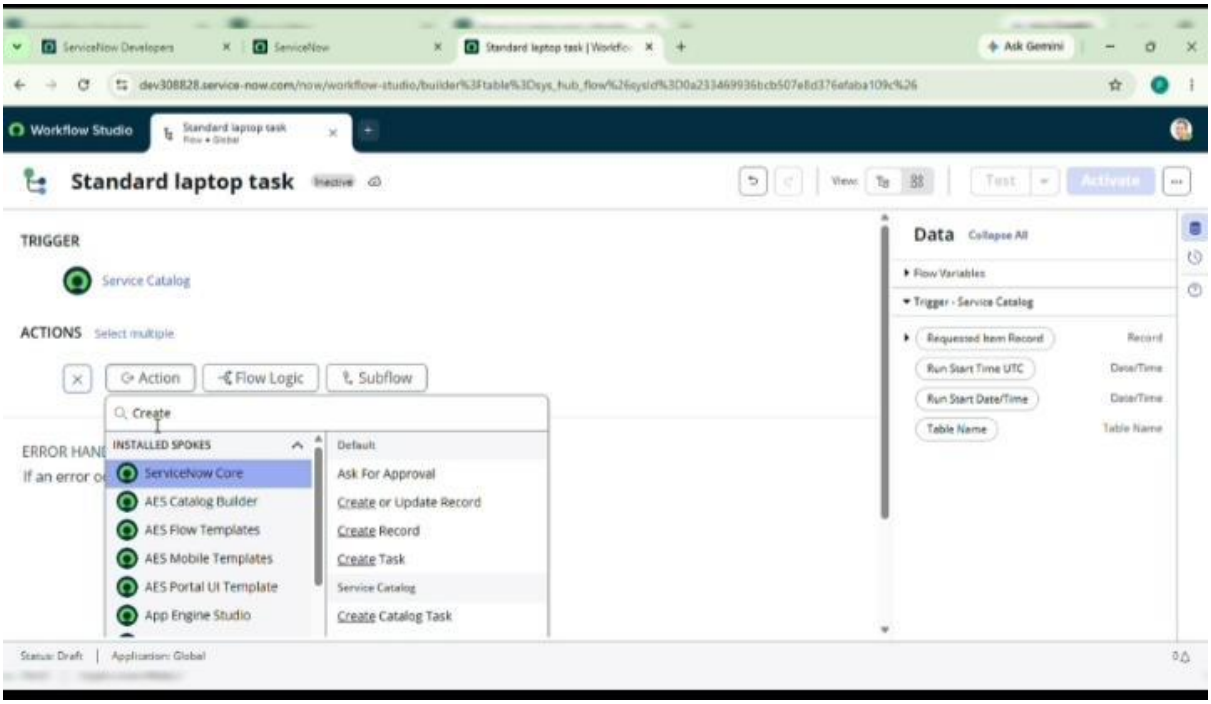
For example, the Laptop Model field identifies the standard laptop required by the employee, while the Business Justification field explains why the laptop is required.

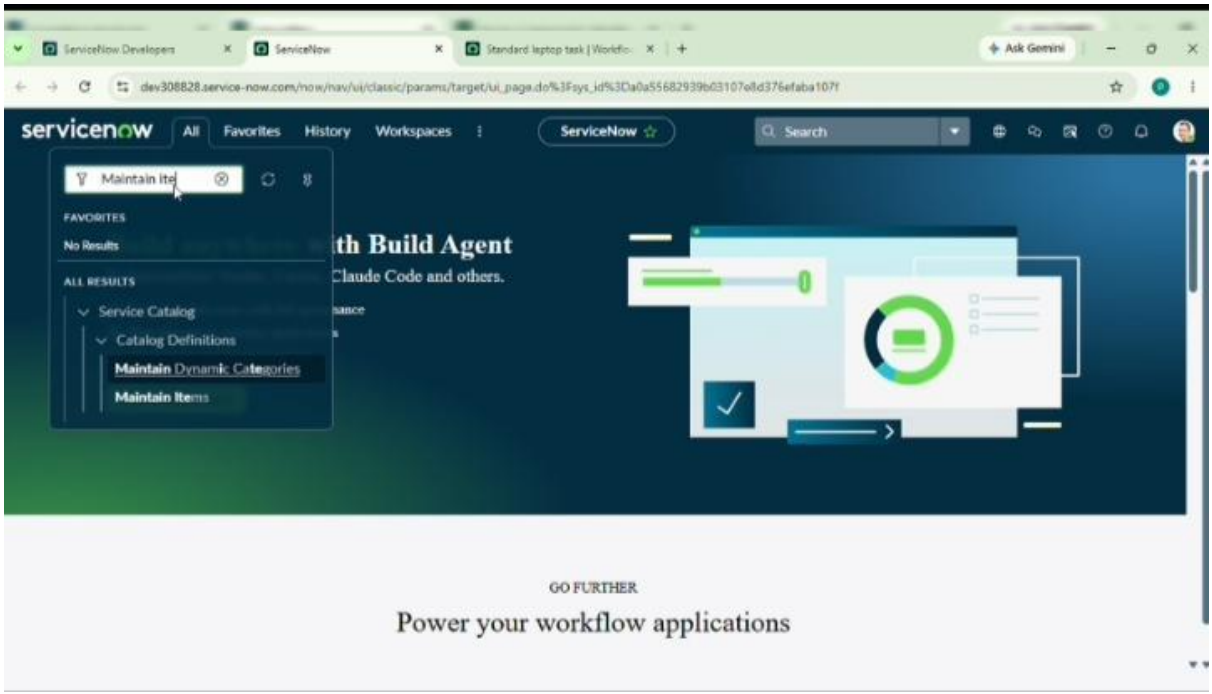
Proper documentation of catalog variables helps administrators understand how information is collected from the employee.

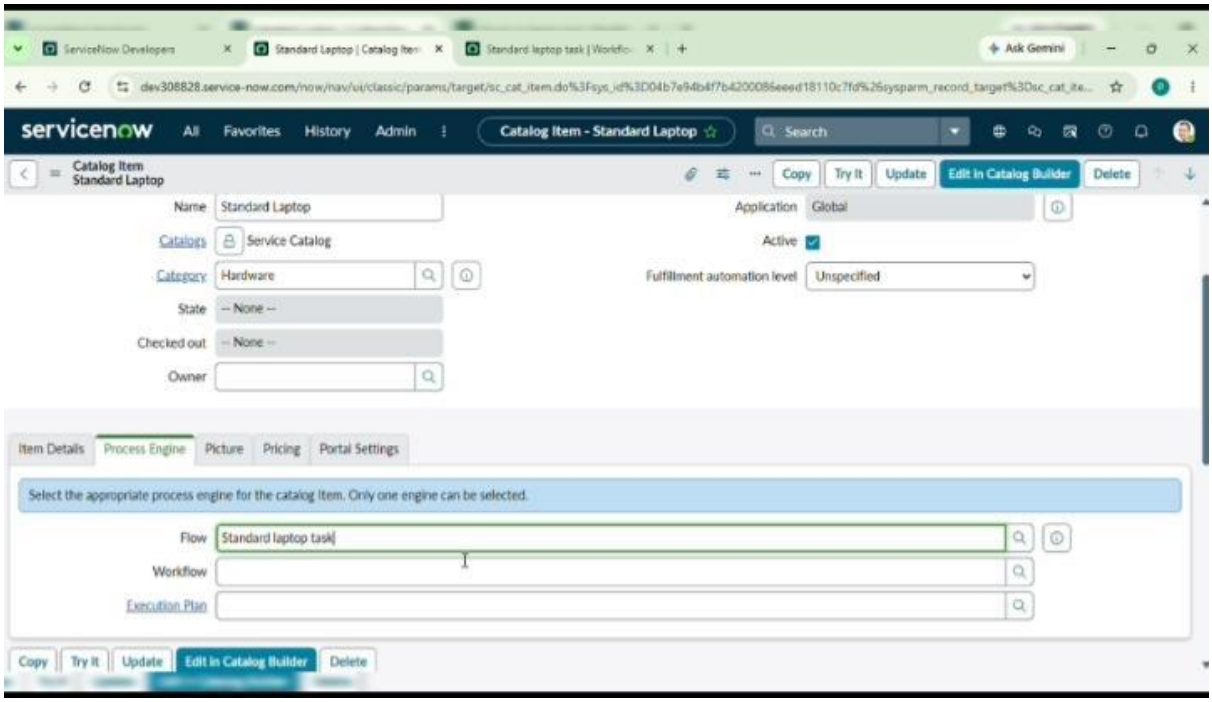


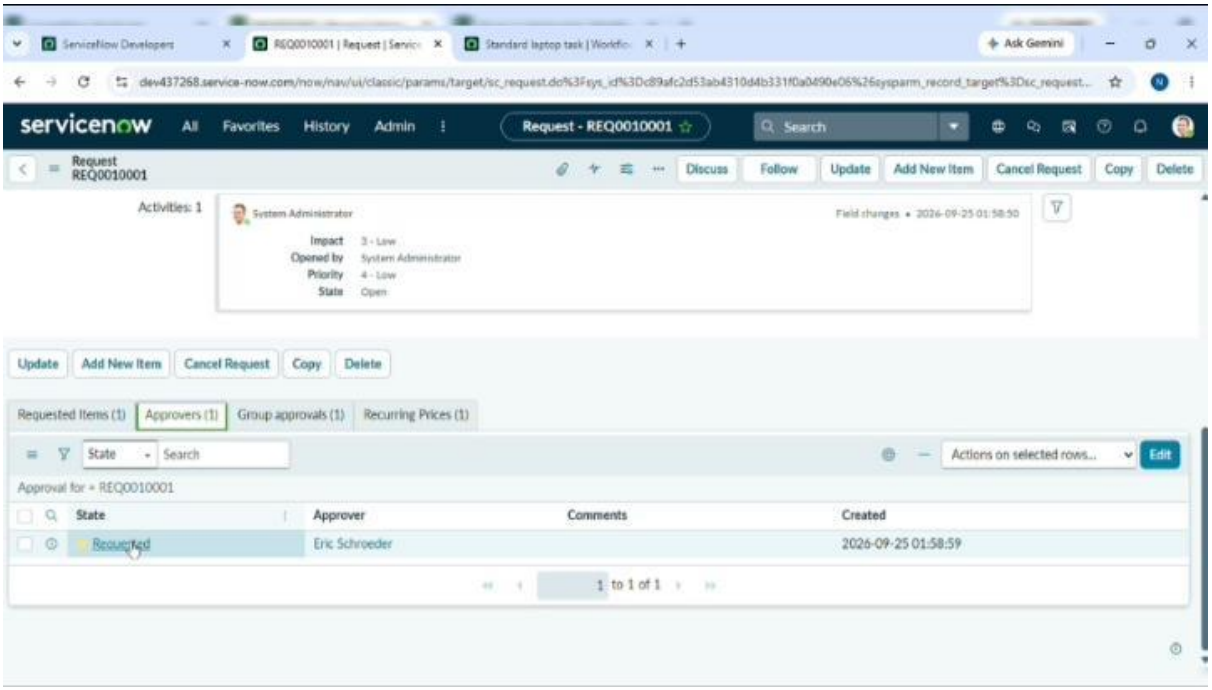


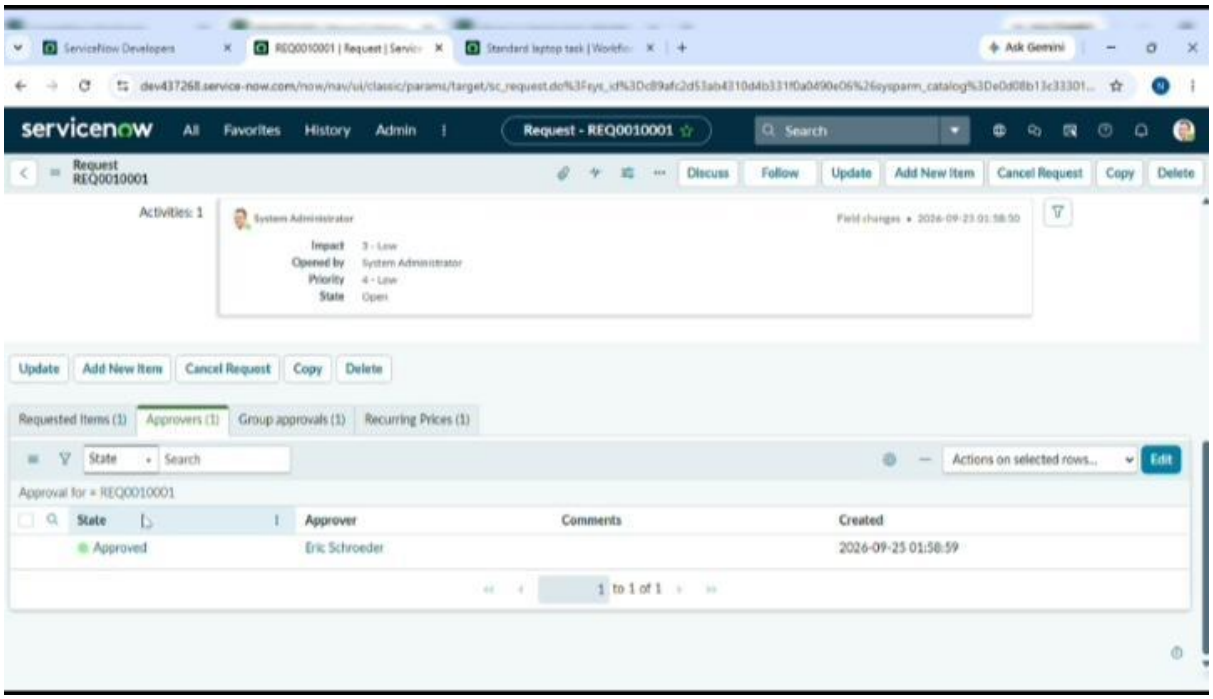

Workflow Studio
Standard laptop task
Inactive
TRIGGER
Abort trigger creation
Trigger
Select a Trigger
Search Triggers
Record
Scheduled
Application
Application
Inbound Email
Knowledge Management
Remote
Service Catalog
Service Catalog
SLA Task
ACTIONS
Select multiple
Add an Action,
ERROR HANDLER
If an error occurs in your f
Data
Flow Variables
Trigger
Status: Draft
Application: Global


Workflow Studio
Standard laptop task
Inactive
TRIGGER
Service Catalog
ACTIONS
Select multiple
Action
Flow Logic
Subflow
Create
INSTALLED SPOKES
ServiceNow Core
AES Catalog Builder
AES Flow Templates
AES Mobile Templates
AES Portal UI Template
App Engine Studio
Default
Ask For Approval
Create or Update Record
Create Record
Create Task
Service Catalog
Create Catalog Task
Data
Collapse All
Flow Variables
Trigger - Service Catalog
Requested Item Record
Record
Run Start Time UTC
Date/Time
Run Start Date/Time
Date/Time
Table Name
Table Name
Status: Draft
Application: Global


servicenow
All
Favorites
History
Workspaces
ServiceNow
Search
Maintain ite
FAVORITES
No Results
ALL RESULTS
Service Catalog
Catalog Definitions
Maintain Dynamic Categories
Maintain Items
th Build Agent
Claude Code and others.
GO FURTHER
Power your workflow applications


servicenow
All
Favorites
History
Admin
Catalog Item - Standard Laptop
Search
Catalog Item
Standard Laptop
Copy
Try It
Update
Edit in Catalog Builder
Delete
Name
Standard Laptop
Application
Global
Catalogs
Service Catalog
Active
Category
Hardware
Fulfillment automation level
Unspecified
State
-- None --
Checked out
-- None --
Owner
Item Details
Process Engine
Picture
Pricing
Portal Settings
Select the appropriate process engine for the catalog Item. Only one engine can be selected.
Flow
Standard laptop task
Workflow
Execution Plan
Copy
Try It
Update
Edit in Catalog Builder
Delete


servicenow
All
Favorites
History
Admin
Request - REQ0010001
Search
Request
REQ0010001
Discuss
Follow
Update
Add New Item
Cancel Request
Copy
Delete
Activities: 1
System Administrator
Field changes • 2026-09-25 01:58:50
Impact 3 - Low
Opened by System Administrator
Priority 4 - Low
State Open
Update
Add New Item
Cancel Request
Copy
Delete
Requested Items (1)
Approvers (1)
Group approvals (1)
Recurring Prices (1)
State
Search
Actions on selected rows...
Edit
Approval for = REQ0010001
State
Approver
Comments
Created
Requested
Eric Schroeder
2026-09-25 01:58:59
1 to 1 of 1


servicenow
All
Favorites
History
Admin
Request - REQ0010001
Search
Request
REQ0010001
Discuss
Follow
Update
Add New Item
Cancel Request
Copy
Delete
Activities: 1
System Administrator
Field changes • 2026-09-25 01:58:50
Impact 3 - Low
Opened by System Administrator
Priority 4 - Low
State Open
Update
Add New Item
Cancel Request
Copy
Delete
Requested Items (1)
Approvers (1)
Group approvals (1)
Recurring Prices (1)
State
Search
Actions on selected rows...
Edit
Approval for = REQ0010001
State
Approver
Comments
Created
Approved
Eric Schroeder
2026-09-25 01:58:59
1 to 1 of 1

4. Flow Designer Documentation

Flow Designer is the main automation component used in this project.

The documentation should clearly explain:

Flow name

Flow purpose

Trigger

Conditions

Actions

Approvals

Tasks

Notifications

Status updates

Flow Trigger

The flow starts when a standard laptop request is submitted.

Flow Actions

After the trigger, the flow can perform several automated actions:

Retrieve the request information.

Check the request details.

Determine whether approval is required.

Send the request for approval.

Process the approval result.

Create a fulfillment task.

Assign the task to the appropriate team.

Update the request status.

Send notifications to relevant users.

Documenting each action in sequence makes the flow easier to understand and maintain.

5. **Approval Process Documentation**

Approval is an important part of the laptop procurement workflow.

The documentation should explain:

Who approves the request.

When approval is required.

What happens after approval.

What happens if the request is rejected.

How the request status changes.

For an approved request, the flow can continue to the fulfillment stage.

For a rejected request, the flow can follow a separate path and update the request accordingly.

This documentation helps administrators understand the decision-making logic within the automated process.

6. **Fulfillment Task Documentation**

After the required approval is completed, Flow Designer can automatically create a fulfillment task.

The documentation should contain:

Task purpose

Assignment group

Task description

Request information

Expected fulfillment activity

Task completion process

The task can be assigned to an IT or procurement team responsible for processing the laptop order.

This reduces the need for employees or administrators to manually create tasks.

7. **Notification Documentation**

Notifications keep users informed about the progress of their requests.

The documentation should describe important notification events such as:

Request submitted

Approval requested

Request approved

Request rejected

Fulfillment task created

Request completed

The documentation should also identify the intended recipients and the information included in each notification.

This helps maintain clear communication between employees, approvers, and IT teams.

8.Standard laptop

Testing documentation records how the automated workflow was validated.

Different scenarios should be tested to ensure that the complete process works correctly.

Sample Test Cases

Test Scenario

Expected Result

Submit valid laptop request

Request is created

Start the flow

Flow triggers correctly

Approval required

Approval is generated

Request approved

Fulfillment task is created

Request rejected

Rejection path is followed

Task created

Correct team receives task

Notification triggered

User receives notification

Request completed

Status is updated

Testing results should be documented with the test case, expected result, actual result, and status.

9. User Guide Documentation

The user guide explains how employees can use the automated laptop procurement system.

Basic Steps

Open the ServiceNow Service Catalog.

Select Standard Laptop Request.

Enter the required employee information.

Select the required laptop details.

Provide the business justification.

Enter the required date.

Review the information.

Submit the request.

Track the request status.

Respond to any required approval-related communication.

A simple user guide reduces confusion and helps employees submit complete and accurate requests.

10. Troubleshooting Documentation

Troubleshooting information helps administrators identify problems in the automation.

Common checks include:

Verify whether the catalog request was created.

Check whether the Flow Designer flow was triggered.

Verify required field values.

Check the approval status.

Verify the assignment group.

Check whether the fulfillment task was created.

Review notification configuration.

Check the request and task status.

These troubleshooting steps can help identify where the workflow stopped or behaved differently from the expected process.

11. Maintenance Documentation

The automated workflow may require updates in the future.

For example:

New laptop models may be added.

Existing laptop models may be removed.

Approval rules may change.

Assignment groups may change.

Notification content may need modification.

Additional procurement steps may be introduced.

All such changes should be documented after implementation and testing.

Maintaining updated documentation ensures that future administrators can understand the latest version of the solution.

12. Security and Access Documentation

Security and access information should also be included in the project documentation.

Only authorized users should be allowed to modify the catalog item or Flow Designer configuration.

Employees should have access to submit the appropriate catalog request, while approvers and fulfillment teams should have access to their respective activities.

Documenting access requirements helps maintain controlled and secure operation of the ServiceNow solution.

13. Future Enhancement

The project can be enhanced in the future according to organizational requirements.

Possible enhancements include:

Adding multiple laptop categories.

Adding inventory availability checks.

Introducing different approval levels.

Integrating procurement systems.

Adding automatic inventory updates.

Creating advanced reports and dashboards.

Adding additional notification options.

Automating more procurement activities.

Future enhancements should also be documented, tested, and reviewed before being introduced into the production process.

Conclusion

The Project Documentation Phase provides a complete and organized record of the automated laptop procurement solution. It documents the business requirements, Service Catalog configuration, Flow Designer workflow, approval process, fulfillment tasks, notifications, testing activities, user instructions, troubleshooting procedures, security considerations, and future enhancements.

Good documentation makes the solution easier to understand, maintain, troubleshoot, and improve. It also ensures that the knowledge gained during the project is preserved for future administrators and users.

Therefore, comprehensive project documentation plays an important role in making the Standard Laptop Order automation using ServiceNow Flow Designer organized, maintainable, and easy to manage.